



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# South Africa: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-19

Edition of 2026-08-19 · 125 systems and instruments tracked, 22 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-19 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 125 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 58 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-19, 8 did not, 36 carry no stated baseline, and 22 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 534 sources for this place in the window — 60 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 474 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

The largest measurable delivery of the twelve months was administrative. Smart identity documents through bank branches went from 30 branches across five banks in August 2025 to [296 branches and more than 385,000 applications in four months](#) by July 2026, and the 1,000-branch target originally set for 2029 was pulled forward to 750 by end-2026.

Against that, three instruments went backwards. The draft national artificial-intelligence policy was [withdrawn in April 2026](#) after fabricated references were found in it. The ministerial policy direction of 11 December 2025 intended to unblock satellite licensing was [rejected by the regulator in May 2026](#). SA Connect phase two was [declared ended in the February 2026 Budget Review](#) rather than completed, against a 2022 cabinet target of universal access in 36 months.

Most stated delivery dates in the period moved.

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                           | AT 2025-08-01                          | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Cape Town internet exchange (CINX)                             | <i>Baseline not held</i>               | Present at six data-centre locations after going live at two further sites, but still concentrated: one facility holds 87 of the exchange's 122 networks and nearly every 100 Gbps port, against 208 networks and 10,132 Gbps on the more distributed Johannesburg exchange | ADVANCED                 |
| Delivered data-centre load                                     | ~350MW (2024 benchmark)                | ~390MW (2025)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED, MARGINAL       |
| Draft Radio Frequency Spectrum and Fees Regulations amendments | Regulations of 2015 and 2010 unamended | Gazetted 2026-05-15; oral hearings 19-20 August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                 |
| Equinix Cape Town land use                                     | <i>Baseline not held</i>               | Tribunal approval 2026-07-14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED                 |
| High-demand spectrum auction                                   | No date                                | The 2026 National Radio Frequency Plan targets 1,145 MHz more mid-band spectrum and over 17,250 MHz of mmWave against 794 MHz currently available - roughly 215% more high-demand spectrum cleared for release - but no auction has been scheduled, priced or gazetted      | STALLED                  |
| IMT Roadmap 2026 and draft assignment plans                    | <i>Baseline not held</i>               | Out for consultation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                 |
| LEO satellite licensing framework                              | Policy direction gazetted 2025-12-12   | Direction rejected 2026-05                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | REGRESSED                |
| National broadband map (DBSA)                                  | None published                         | Launched 2026-03-31                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                 |
| National Radio Frequency Plan 2026                             | <i>Baseline not held</i>               | Gazetted 2026-07-24                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                 |
| SA Connect phase 2                                             | Suspended pending rollover (2025-09)   | Declared ended (2026-02)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | CLOSED                   |
| Satellite market entry via section 13                          | <i>Baseline not held</i>               | Amazon Leo-Herotel, 2026-07-15                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                 |
| State Digital Infrastructure Company (network merger)          | Road map due FY2025/26                 | Implementation moved to FY2028/29                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | REGRESSED                |
| National cyber-security measurement                            | 2024 CSIR surveys                      | Unchanged; no re-measurement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | NO CHANGE                |
| National CSIRT (Cybersecurity Hub)                             | BASELINE NOT HELD                      | Operating; no incident statistics published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National Cybersecurity Policy Framework                        | BASELINE NOT HELD                      | In force; the instrument the national CSIRT rests on                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| National GIS infrastructure database (rapid deployment reg. 7) | BASELINE NOT HELD                      | In development (2026-04-12)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT  | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19          | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|----------|
| Teraco CT2, Cape Town | <i>Baseline not held</i> | +32MW to 50MW, 2025-11 | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Johannesburg data-centre expansion | Not held      | An international operator is scaling its Johannesburg facility to 24MW and holds a ZAR7.5bn South African expansion budget covering that site plus banked land in Johannesburg and Cape Town, with further build-out held pending demand | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

### Technical Capacity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                           | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| National Integrated Cyber Infrastructure System | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Operating; CHPC at maximum capacity, expansion required | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| FSCA enforcement against online financial harm               | 107 public warnings; R119.8m penalties (FY2024/25) | 140 public warnings; R2.89bn penalties on 76 persons (FY2025/26)                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Ransomware attacker dwell time                               | 117 days (2024)                                    | 18 days in 2025 on a digital-forensics firm's own incident statistics, with some intrusions running start to finish inside a day, attributed to ransomware-as-a-service, automated reconnaissance and AI-assisted attacks              | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| Departmental information security officer training programme | Not held                                           | The public service and administration department is tendering to build a training programme for departmental information security officers across the public sector, to implement the directive on public service information security | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                        | MOVEMENT        |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Electronic Communications Amendment Bill | <i>Baseline not held</i> | Published; submissions to 2026-08-21 | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                      | MOVEMENT         |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------|------------------|
| Draft National Policy on Data and Cloud | Draft         | Draft; date of instrument disputed | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

SA Connect closed rather than delivered. Its in-year allocation collapsed from an expected R1.1bn to R116m, money arrived only in January 2026 and equipment in the final month of the financial year; the Budget Review recorded 6,343 government facilities and 32,055 hotspots, with R888.8m over the medium term to maintain 948 phase-one sites. The state network merger moved the other way: the FY2025/26 deliverable was a finalised road map, and the annual performance plan tabled in March 2026 starts again with a preliminary report and implementation in FY2028/29.

On satellite, an instrument was issued and neutralised within five months. Starlink launched in its [27th African country in July 2026](#) without entering South Africa, while Amazon took the acquisition route the Act already allows.

Announced data-centre capacity and delivered capacity diverged. Pipeline announcements would take national load [above 1,200MW](#); delivered live load moved from roughly 350MW to 390MW, and the only completed facility of scale in the period was [Teraco's 50MW CT2](#). No national cyber-security measurement was repeated during the twelve months.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT           |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| MzansiXchange data exchange                             | One-year pilot launched 2025-10-09 | Nine months in; extra capacity onboarding                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED, STALLING |
| SAHPRA VigiFlow serious-adverse-event e-reporting pilot | Did not exist                      | Pilot open by invitation; no duration or mandatory date published                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ADVANCED           |
| SARS-Malawi customs data exchange                       | Did not exist                      | Signed; no go-live date stated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED           |
| Digital VAT model                                       | Not held                           | Out to consultation: the revenue service proposes a five-corner digital VAT model of electronic invoicing, an interoperability framework and electronic reporting, moving toward VAT auto-assessment, with a phased rollout from 2026/27 and stakeholder feedback due 16 October 2026 | BASELINE NOT HELD  |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Digital driving licence                           | Promised for 2026                     | Nearest dated milestone 2027-03                                                                                                                                                                                        | STALLED  |
| Draft Identification Regulations amendments       | Did not exist                         | Gazetted 2026-05-04; consultation closed                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED |
| Electronic travel authorisation                   | Pilot from 2025-10                    | Live at four airports — OR Tambo, Cape Town, King Shaka and Lanseria — from 2026-08-12, with 6,126 fraudulent applications rejected, put at 2.8% of pilot submissions, and full visa-type rollout targeted by end-2026 | ADVANCED |
| National digital identity (credential and wallet) | "Before the 2029 elections" (2025-12) | Hosting 2027-03-31; credentials 2027/28                                                                                                                                                                                | STALLED  |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                | AT 2025-08-01                                       | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Capitec-Walletdoc merger conditions | Did not exist                                       | Behavioural conditions agreed; Tribunal had not ruled at 2026-08-06                                  | ADVANCED |
| CIPS participation (Standard Bank)  | No African bank held CIPS direct-participant status | Standard Bank live as the first African bank offering CIPS transactions; RMB the settlement currency | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                                            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                       | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Renminbi Clearing Bank of Africa</b>                       | Did not exist; CIPS participation only (live 2025-11-20) | Standard Bank and ICBC jointly authorised as RMB clearing bank for Africa, with operational capacity in the 19 African countries where Standard Bank Group operates | ADVANCED          |
| <b>ZARU rand-backed stablecoin</b>                            | Did not exist                                            | Listed on Luno Global 2026-08-07, quoted against USDT and USDC                                                                                                      | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Payments Ecosystem Modernisation credential and wallet</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                 | In development (2026-07-31)                                                                                                                                         | Baseline not held |
| <b>Retail central bank digital currency</b>                   | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                 | Planned, not proceeding (2026-07-02)                                                                                                                                | Baseline not held |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                            | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Blocked identity numbers</b>        | 384,189 (2025-12)        | 377,060                                                  | STALLED                  |
| <b>Intelligent Population Register</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In development (2026-07-07)                              | Baseline not held        |
| <b>National Population Register</b>    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Implemented (2026-07-29)                                 | Baseline not held        |
| <b>Uncollected identity documents</b>  | Baseline not held        | 360,000 uncollected at Home Affairs offices (2026-07-31) | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                | AT 2026-08-19                                                | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>NSFAS student funding system</b>               | Board dissolved 2024 over IT-system failures | Under administration; ICT named the largest operational risk | REGRESSED |
| <b>National Digital Health Strategy 2019-2024</b> | Term already expired                         | No successor strategy held                                   | NO CHANGE |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                               | AT 2025-08-01                                        | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Batho Pele AI chatbot</b>                                       | Did not exist                                        | DPSA-Meta-Juicetel partnership built on Meta's Llama models, providing policy, circular and legislation lookups to citizens and public servants; nine official languages targeted; explicitly decision-support only, with no decision-making authority                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Home Affairs system downtime</b>                                | 35,426 hours of nationwide system downtime (2024/25) | 13,867 hours in 2025/26, a 61% reduction, with provincial gains ranging from 79% in the Free State to 41% in North West; the population register's own downtime fell from 14,720 to 11,479 hours, a 22% improvement. The department attributes it to the state IT agency moving from a bronze to a silver service level, 226 links migrated to fibre, 182 offices moved to a web service manager and 439 offices running on the identification system | ADVANCED          |
| <b>IEC digital voter registration (WhatsApp and online portal)</b> | Online portal only                                   | 1.7m registration transactions over the final weekend; 291,016 first-time registrations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED          |
| <b>MyMzansi single citizen application</b>                         | Prototype; public access H1 2026                     | Production-ready pilot; stable platform 2026-09                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED, SLIPPED |
| <b>National payment code standard (QR+)</b>                        | Did not exist                                        | v1.2, eight-bank test cohort                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| PayInc and the SARB stake                                   | 50% acquired 2025-10              | Bank-owned utility; non-bank shareholding ruled out (2026-07-31)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |
| PayShap                                                     | Baseline not held                 | 905m transactions by 2026-05                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED          |
| Smart ID and bank-branch channel                            | 30 branches, five banks (2025-08) | Smart identity services running at participating bank branches - 372 on the department's own count at 17 August, and over 408 on its downtime statement of 10 August - with more than half a million people having used the channel to date; on 17 August the department launched a My Home Affairs Online portal to help citizens find a participating branch, framed with the electronic travel authorisation as a building block of the national digital public infrastructure roadmap | ADVANCED          |
| Smart IDs issued, calendar year                             | Baseline not held                 | 4,002,964 in 2025, +17%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED          |
| Western Cape Infrastructure Virtual Platform (EVE AI agent) | Did not exist                     | Automatically evaluates projects against Treasury rules and ISO 9001 via AI agent EVE; evaluated pipeline of 52 projects worth R132bn, 11 worth over R20bn to be released to market; MoUs signed with Infrastructure South Africa, IFISA, EDC South Africa and UCT                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED          |
| Gauteng online school admissions                            | In operation since 2016           | 2027 intake opened 2026-08-05                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE         |
| National Health Insurance information architecture          | In force since 2022-10-21         | In force; no implementation measurement held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE         |
| Courts digitisation project                                 | Not held                          | Records storage has been outsourced to a private contractor since 2021 across three provinces; on 13 August 2026 the justice minister referred the project to the special investigating unit and the police priority crimes unit after the contractor denied the department access to its own records at the Master of the High Court in Pretoria                                                                                                                                         | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| Digital matric certificate                                  | BASELINE NOT HELD                 | Piloting (2026-08-03)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Baseline not held |
| Minimum Interoperability Standards and GWEA                 | BASELINE NOT HELD                 | In development (2026-07-31)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Baseline not held |
| Online Verification Service                                 | BASELINE NOT HELD                 | Implemented (undated)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Baseline not held |

## Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                          | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19           | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|
| National Identification and Registration Bill | BASELINE NOT HELD | Still before Parliament | Baseline not held |

The digital identity schedule slipped at every stated milestone. A deadline of April 2025 for cabinet approval of the legal framework was missed; the roadmap milestone of a functional digital identity by the end of the 2025 financial year was missed; the President told Parliament on 12 February 2026 that digital identity and the digital driving licence would [launch during 2026](#); and the department's own plan, tabled six weeks later, [put hosting at 31 March 2027 and operation at 2027/28](#). The draft regulations were nonetheless made and consulted on within the period, and an objection that they may be ultra vires of the Identification Act remains unanswered.

Blocked identity numbers fell by 7,129 in roughly seven months, from 384,189 to [377,060](#), against 702,267 at judgment and a court deadline now running to March 2027. MyMzansi's first public access moved from March 2026 to September 2026. MzansiXchange, launched as a one-year pilot in October 2025, was [nine months in and](#)

onboarding further technical capacity at the period's end, with no date set for the rollout decision the pilot was to trigger. Payments moved fastest: PayShap went from 461m cumulative transactions in March 2026 to 905m by May, and the central bank became co-owner of the rail in October 2025.

## Governance and regulation

### Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19            | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Digital Transformation of Government Roadmap | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Implemented (2025-04-03) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01                         | AT 2026-08-19                                        | MOVEMENT                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Capital Flow Management Regulations and Crypto Asset Manual   | Did not exist                         | Both in draft; manual comments to end-September 2026 | <b>ADVANCED</b>            |
| Copyright Amendment Bill                                      | <i>Baseline not held</i>              | Constitutional Court ruling 2026-06                  | <b>ADVANCED</b>            |
| End-user and Subscriber Service Charter Amendment Regulations | In consultation                       | Gazetted 2026-01-23; under review application        | <b>ADVANCED, LITIGATED</b> |
| Operation Vulindlela reporting                                | 80% of initiatives on track (2026-04) | "Uneven and slower than anticipated"                 | <b>REGRESSED</b>           |
| POPIA enforcement notices                                     | None held                             | Three notices, May–June 2026                         | <b>ADVANCED</b>            |
| SADC real-time settlement                                     | Rand only since 2013                  | Kwanza added 2026-07-27                              | <b>ADVANCED</b>            |
| Breach notification rate                                      | ~284 per month (Apr–Nov 2025)         | ~263 per month (Q1 2026)                             | <b>NO CHANGE</b>           |
| National Open Science Policy                                  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>              | Implemented (undated)                                | <i>Baseline not held</i>   |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                 | AT 2025-08-01                                                                      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Cost to Communicate Roadmap                          | Did not exist; no successor instrument after the 2019 Data Services Market Inquiry | Study out to tender; no roadmap published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>ADVANCED</b>          |
| ICT indicators and scenario-modelling system to 2050 | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                           | Tendered by the communications department to steer the digital economy to 2050, framed against the National Digital Transformation Roadmap, the Presidential Commission on the Fourth Industrial Revolution and the Digital Economy Masterplan; no award, value or delivery date published     | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Mega infrastructure project monitoring dashboard     | Not held                                                                           | A joint push by the Presidency and the planning and evaluation department to fast-track a digital dashboard monitoring mega infrastructure projects, put before the parliamentary committee on the Presidency alongside a wider review of progress against the state-of-the-nation commitments | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Operation Vulindlela Phase II                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                           | Implemented (2026-07-31)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT           | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19            | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| ICT and Media Regulators Forum | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Implemented (2026-07-31) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19               | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| Consumer Protection Act direct-marketing opt-out registry        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In development (2026-04-20) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Mandatory breach reporting e-portal                              | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Implemented (2025-04-15)    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| Protection of Personal Information Act and Information Regulator | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Implemented (2026-07-06)    | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

Enforcement began during the period. The Information Regulator issued its [first 2026 enforcement notice in May](#), a [precedent-setting access-to-information notice against a mining company in June](#), and a third treating a misdirected email as a reportable breach — while the monthly breach-notification rate stayed broadly flat and the statutory maximum penalty remained R10m.

Operation Vulindlela's own reporting changed within the period: a briefing in April 2026 put [80% of digital transformation initiatives on track](#) with 20% complete; the July report replaces that quantified claim with a qualitative statement that progress has been uneven. No later percentage is on record.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19               | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| Conduct of Financial Institutions Bill | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | In development (2026-01-30) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT | AT 2025-08-01                                          | AT 2026-08-19                                    | MOVEMENT         |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| National AI policy   | Cabinet March 2026, finalise FY2026/27 (as at 2026-02) | No gazetted policy; cabinet Nov 2026 or Jan 2027 | <b>REGRESSED</b> |



## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01             | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Crypto-asset service provider licensing | 300 licences (2025-12-31) | Licensing of centralised crypto-asset service providers is in force, but the regulator states the model has no purchase on decentralised finance - protocols with no company, board or natural person to hold accountable - and plans to attach obligations elsewhere; no instrument for DeFi is published | NO CHANGE         |
| AI-in-finance regulatory framework      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>  | Planned (2026-07-16)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held |

## AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                               | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Automated selection at SARS                        | Baseline not held                           | 100% of verifications, 88.41% of complex audits                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED                 |
| Proposed AI regulatory institutions                | Seven bodies proposed                       | Under reconsideration; committee opposed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | REGRESSED                |
| SAHPRA AI/ML medical-device requirements           | Did not exist                               | Issued 2025-09-26; product registration not commenced                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | ADVANCED                 |
| Start-up funding, South Africa                     | Led Africa on equity and deal count, CY2025 | Fourth at \$83m, H1 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | REGRESSED                |
| Enterprise AI adoption at a major bank             | Not held                                    | More than 39,000 staff, 72% of the workforce, reported as active generative-artificial-intelligence users on a multi-model enterprise platform hosted on a foreign cloud provider, with relationship management, servicing, payments and lending named as the four priority areas | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| Machine-learning screening of travellers for fraud | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                    | Stated intention to screen travellers for fraud using machine learning; no system, procurement, legal basis, accuracy measure or appeal route is published                                                                                                                        | Baseline not held        |
| SARS Modernisation 3.0                             | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                    | In development (2026-07-23)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held        |

## ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| B-BBEE ICT Sector Council | Baseline not held | The communications minister replaced the council's chairperson and appointed an interim chair for six months after a departmental investigation found the council dysfunctional; the investigation report is not published, and no remedial plan, terms of reference for the interim period or date for a permanent appointment is stated | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

The AI policy changed kind as well as date. A timeline reported in February 2026 had cabinet consideration in March and finalisation within FY2026/27; the draft was published on 2 April, withdrawn later that month, a review panel was appointed on 14 May, and the department stated on 29 July that the replacement [will issue guidelines rather than prescribe rules](#). Automated decision-making expanded through the same period without a governing framework.

Funding reversed within the period. South Africa raised **\$335.9m across 42 ventures in calendar 2025** on a measure its publisher describes as a minimum floor, leading the continent; in the first half of 2026 it **ranked fourth at \$83m** as continental deal count fell 42% year on year.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                             | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Bank-account means test across eight grants       | Appeal opposed<br>2026-01-28              | Undecided; SCA hearing 2026-08-25                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | STALLED                                      |
| MICT SETA                                         | Baseline not held                         | Referred for assessment 2026-07-21                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | REGRESSED                                    |
| Postbank Black Card migration                     | 463,836 active gold cards<br>(2026-04-29) | 172,146 replaced by 2026-07-28; 264,263 outstanding                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                                     |
| SASSA biometric verification against Home Affairs | 42,000 in first two weeks<br>(2025-09)    | 997,379 of 19.05m recipients (2026-03)                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED, PARTIAL                            |
| SASSA grant reviews                               | Biometric enrolment live<br>2025-09-01    | 420,000 flagged; ~160,000 incomplete                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED IN SCOPE,<br>REGRESSED IN<br>ACCESS |
| SITA performance                                  | Baseline not held                         | R2.07bn irregular over four years                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | REGRESSED                                    |
| Smartphone excise removal                         | Removed April 2025                        | 1.1m additional entry-level units                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | ADVANCED                                     |
| DCDT expenditure                                  | Baseline not held                         | R3.61bn of R3.74bn spent, FY2025/26                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE                                    |
| Disability-inclusive data cooperation with China  | Not held                                  | A seven-point plan agreed to deepen cooperation on disability-inclusive data, universal design and artificial-intelligence-enabled assistive technology, anchored in a proposed disability centre of excellence working with the national statistics office | BASELINE NOT HELD                            |

### Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01          | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| National Digital and Future Skills Strategy 2020  | 2020 strategy in force | Under review; no replacement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | STALLED           |
| Digital-skills pipeline from school to employment | Baseline not held      | Constrained at both ends: young people entering without the foundational digital skills the workplace needs, and employers unable to fill digital vacancies alongside high unemployment; the mismatch is found to be structural and not self-correcting (2026-08) | BASELINE NOT HELD |
| National Competency Framework                     | BASELINE NOT HELD      | In development (2026-07-23)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Baseline not held |

Grant verification widened during the period. Biometric enrolment began on 1 September 2025 and had reached **997,379 of 19.05m recipients by March 2026**, about 5%; 420,000 grants were flagged during 2025/26 and roughly 160,000 beneficiaries did not complete the review, with **child-grant recipients reporting months without payment**. The litigation that would settle the mechanism was neither implemented nor decided within the twelve months.

At the State Information Technology Agency, a Public Service Commission investigation reported [R2.07bn of irregular expenditure across four audited years](#) and annual performance plan achievement of 42.86% in FY2024/25; the 30-day deadline for a recovery plan expired within the period, and no plan is recorded.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Science and Technology Accelerator-Systems, Southern Africa | Baseline not held | Up to GBP2.5m over three years to March 2030, of which up to GBP400,000 for 2026/27, covering artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and digital access alongside climate, energy, health and space; South Africa the primary focus, Zimbabwe and Zambia the first year's | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

This section holds one row and it opened at the very end of the period, so there is no movement to report over the twelve months — only an arrival. On 11 August the United Kingdom [opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030](#), with South Africa its primary focus. No delivery consortium has been chosen, so the programme has a ceiling and a subject matter and nothing else yet. The rest of South Africa's digital financing sits outside this ledger, in the domestic budget lines and private data-centre capital recorded elsewhere in this report.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                            | LAST PROBED    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority) | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Education management information systems                            | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Electronic death registration system                                | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations                       | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Malabo Convention ratification position                             | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication                         | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Rules governing state automated decision-making                     | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| AI incident or assurance register                                   | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Digital inclusion strategy instrument                               | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| National digital literacy measurement                               | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Municipal ICT expenditure data                                      | —                                                                                                               | not yet probed |
| Innovation spectrum, lower 6GHz                                     | The gazette notice releasing lower-6 GHz innovation spectrum, or an ICASA decision or licence record naming it. | 2026-08-14     |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                             | LAST PROBED |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| District Health Information System                                  | A National Department of Health statement, annual report or tender record for the District Health Information System, including the hosting arrangement put out to tender in 2026-07.            | 2026-08-14  |
| Non-bank payment service provider licensing                         | The National Payment System Act amendment bill or a SARB directive establishing a licensing regime for non-bank payment service providers.                                                       | 2026-08-14  |
| SAMOS real-time gross settlement                                    | A South African Reserve Bank statement, annual report or system document on SAMOS, which the base carries no source for at any date.                                                             | 2026-08-14  |
| Cybercrimes Act                                                     | The gazetted Cybercrimes Act 19 of 2020 with its commencement proclamation, or a prosecution or enforcement record under it.                                                                     | 2026-08-14  |
| Information Regulator appropriation                                 | The Information Regulator's annual report or the Justice vote's appropriation line naming its allocation.                                                                                        | 2026-08-14  |
| Expert review panel                                                 | The ministerial notice or departmental statement appointing the expert review panel and naming its members and terms of reference.                                                               | 2026-08-14  |
| Prudential Authority AI and cloud supervision standards             | A Prudential Authority directive, guidance note or consultation paper on artificial-intelligence and cloud supervision standards.                                                                | 2026-08-14  |
| Sector-level AI strategies                                          | A departmental or sector-regulator statement naming a sector-level artificial-intelligence strategy and its status.                                                                              | 2026-08-14  |
| Analogue television switch-off date                                 | a gazetted or ministerially announced switch-off date, or a departmental statement of the criteria and household threshold that would set one                                                    | 2026-08-14  |
| Institutional policy on artificial intelligence in higher education | a sector instrument from the higher education department or the quality council, or a published institutional policy on artificial intelligence in teaching and assessment at a named university | 2026-08-17  |

Seventeen of the fifty-three rows above carry *Baseline not held* at the opening date. Almost all fall in the same five months. The base holds no South African domestic payments source published between August and December 2025, so PayShap volumes, the central bank's October 2025 acquisition of half the payment company, the payment code standard and the social grant card migration are all reconstructed from January 2026 onward. The electronic travel authorisation launched in October 2025 and is first recorded in a February 2026 secondary source. The licensing inquiry that has blocked satellite network licences since August 2025 has no primary document on file at all. Without August to December 2025, this twelve-month comparison is in several places a seven-month one.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-19</b>                                                                                                                                                   |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZAF/ZAF-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZAF/ZAF-progress.html</a>                     |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.